



Sri Parvathi Jadala Ramalingeshwara Swamy Devasthanam

శ్రీ పార్వతీ జడల రామలింగేశ్వర స్వామి దేవస్థానం

Cheruvugattu, Narketpally Mandal, Nalgonda District, Telangana

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Sthala Puranam

THE SHLOKA

శ్లో॥ శ్రీమద్భార్గవరామనిర్మితమహాదివ్యాలయేనంస్థితం
నీహరాచలకన్యకార్థవపుషంబాలేందురేఖాధరం |
బ్రహ్మాండ్రాచ్యుతసేవ్యపాదజలజంసద్భక్తకల్పధృమం
సేవేనుందరక్షశైలనిలయం శ్రీరామలింగంభజే ॥

INTRODUCTION

In the Treta Yuga, there lived an immensely powerful emperor named Kartavirya Arjuna. He was extraordinarily strong and possessed a thousand arms. One day, he went hunting in the forest with his entire retinue. Tired from the hunt, the king arrived at the nearby hermitage of the sage-king Jamadagni to rest. Sage Jamadagni, with the help of his divine wish-fulfilling cow Shabala, was able to arrange a sumptuous feast with all six flavours for the emperor's entire retinue within a very short time. Delighted by this, Kartavirya Arjuna asked the sage to give him the wish-fulfilling cow. Jamadagni advised him, saying, "O King! By the power of its penance, this cow stays on its own accord only with sages; it cannot be kept by force by anyone." Ignoring these words, the emperor ordered his soldiers to forcibly bring the cow and its calf to his kingdom. Having no other option, Jamadagni went to the cow and prayed, "O Mother! I am unable to protect you. Protect yourself, and thereby protect me too." Then, from a hair on the cow's body, a warrior fully equipped with weapons emerged and, in an instant, destroyed Kartavirya Arjuna's entire army. Unable to contain his anger, Kartavirya Arjuna came to wage war against Jamadagni, whereupon the sage's son, Parashurama, defeated him. Kartavirya Arjuna, burning with the desire for revenge, waited for a time when Parashurama was away, attacked the hermitage, and beheaded Sage Jamadagni. When Parashurama returned to the hermitage and learned of this, he flew into a towering rage, attacked Kartavirya Arjuna's kingdom, severed his thousand arms, and slew him. Even then, his anger unabated, Parashurama circled the earth twenty-one times, slaying every Kshatriya he encountered, and donated the entire earth as a gift to the foremost of Brahmins, Kashyapa Prajapati, the mind-born son of Brahma. At the sacred ford of Shamantapanchaka, he offered tarpana (libations) to his father Jamadagni with that Kshatriya blood. Thereafter, for the welfare of the universe and wishing the world to flourish in peace and happiness, he consecrated Shiva Lingas at 108 sacred sites, pouring the power of his penance — accumulated over hundreds of thousands of years — into each Shiva Linga he installed at every site, thereby establishing peace throughout the universe.

Of the 108 Shiva Lingas consecrated by Parashurama, the last was installed at the Cheruvugattu kshetram. Even after performing penance here with unwavering devotion for hundreds of thousands of years, Shiva did not appear before him. Enraged, Parashurama struck the Shiva Linga he had installed with his axe (Parashu). Lord Shiva then appeared and declared, “For all these years you have performed penance and pleased me; this kshetram shall shine as one of the most renowned holy places. From here until the end of Kali Yuga, I shall remain and fulfil the long-cherished desires of my devotees,” and with this promise, vanished. Since that day, this kshetram has flourished, growing more glorious day by day, gaining fame as an illustrious Shaiva kshetram, and shining as a place of great sanctity for devotees. In this Devasthanam, the temple of Sri Parvathi Devi lies at the foot of the hill (Gattu). In the temple at the foot of the hill, Sri Parvathi Devi is enshrined, with Sri Mallikarjuna Swamy, Subrahmanya Swamy, and Sri Bhadrakali Veerabhadra Swamy as attendant deities. Atop the hill, Sri Swamy’s attendant deities are Sri Vighneshwara Swamy, Sri Anjaneya Swamy, and Sri Yellamma Devi, with Kalabhairava Swamy as the Kshetrapalaka (guardian deity); and it is believed that the revered Urdhva Linga atop the three sacred rock pools (Moodu Gundlu), along with the Gogarbha pond beside the Koneru, fulfil the heartfelt wishes of devotees. In this kshetram, Sri Swamy is worshipped by devotees as the Arogyapradata (bestower of health).

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